Deadman College of Humanities and Science
Department of Economics
Javier Gonzalez | Economics Ph.D. Candidate
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https://jjgecon.github.io

Teaching Statement

My goal as an educator is to make the powerful framework of economics accessible and applicable for every student. My teaching philosophy is built on two principles: clarity and learning by doing.

My first principle is to translate complex economic theories into clear, simple terms. Since the formal language of economics can be a barrier, I act as a translator, bridging the gap between technical jargon and students' everyday intuition. This means teaching in "two languages": formal and intuitive. For example, while tutoring student-athletes at SMU, I explain elasticity as the sensitivity of quantity demanded to price changes. I complement this with formulas and graphs to show how economists use these concepts, translating ideas into math for rigorous analysis. This approach helps students from all backgrounds grasp core concepts and build a strong foundation.

Second, research shows that learning occurs through active engagement with the content. In my classroom, economic principles are treated as tools to be used, not facts to be memorized. When I taught an undergraduate Price Theory course, I dedicated a significant portion of each class to a hands-on workshop. During these workshops, students tackled problems individually or in small groups while I circulated through the classroom to offer targeted guidance and ask probing questions. At the end of each workshop, I review the exercise with the class, reinforcing concepts in a low-stakes environment where mistakes are learning opportunities. The student evaluations, which averaged 4.7/5, consistently showed that students learned more from this format and enjoyed it more than traditional lectures. Comments frequently highlighted the supportive environment where students felt comfortable asking questions, my willingness to help, and the time dedicated to in-class examples.

The most rewarding aspect of teaching is witnessing students' growth. A highlight was when several student-athletes in my Price Theory course earned perfect scores on the final exam. Their excitement in mastering a subject they once found intimidating was a powerful affirmation of my philosophy: when complex ideas are made clear and students actively practice, anyone can excel. Ultimately, my teaching is driven by the goal of empowering students, transforming economics into a practical toolkit that equips them with the enduring ability to analyze the world around them.

Southern Methodist University
Dedman - Summer 2023 - 1234

Course: IntermediateMicroeconomics00111234: ECO3301-0011-1234-ECO3301 Sect 0011 1234 : Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez

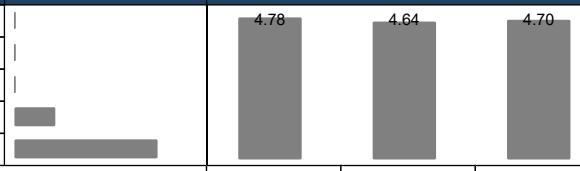
Instructor: Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez *

Response Rate: 9/21 (42.86 %)

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The instructor clearly defined and explained the course objectives and expectations.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		

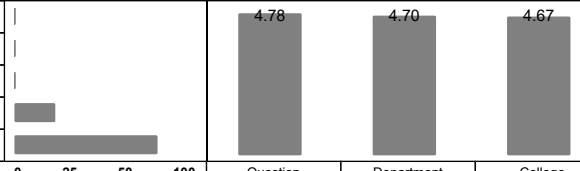


Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.64	0.49	5.00	221	4.70	0.60	5.00

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The instructor utilized class time effectively.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		

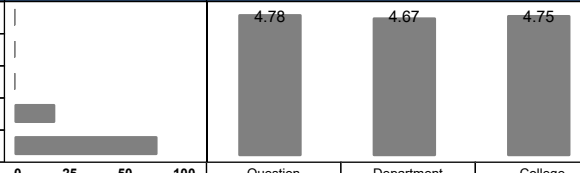


Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.70	0.47	5.00	220	4.67	0.65	5.00

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The instructor was available to answer questions inside and outside of class.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		

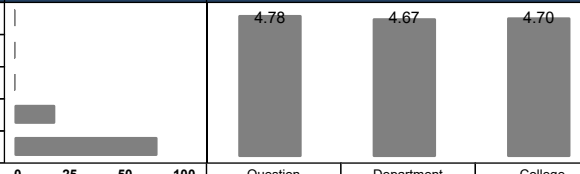


Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.67	0.48	5.00	220	4.75	0.56	5.00

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The course was intellectually challenging or thought-provoking.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.67	0.48	5.00	220	4.70	0.60	5.00

Southern Methodist University
Dedman - Summer 2023 - 1234

Course: IntermediateMicroeconomics00111234: ECO3301-0011-1234-ECO3301 Sect 0011 1234 : Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez

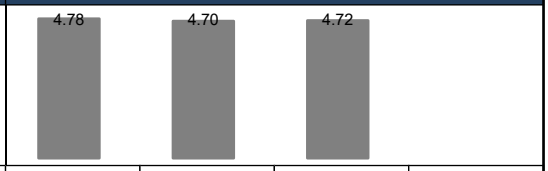
Instructor: Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez *

Response Rate: 9/21 (42.86 %)

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The course helped me to develop knowledge or skills.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		

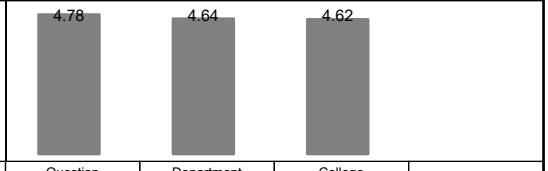


Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.70	0.47	5.00	220	4.72	0.57	5.00

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The instructor presented the course content effectively.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	2	22.22%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	77.78%		

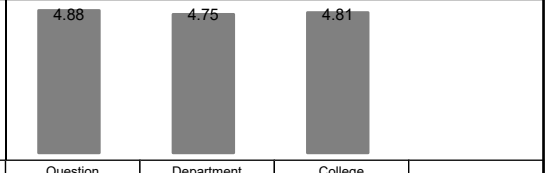


Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.78	0.44	5.00	33	4.64	0.49	5.00	219	4.62	0.75	5.00

1 - Your feedback helps improve teaching at SMU. The following questions are asked for all SMU courses. Please give thoughtful consideration to each question.

The instructor fostered an academic environment that was respectful to students.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	0	0.00%		
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	1	12.50%		
Strongly agree	(5)	7	87.50%		



Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
8/21 (38.10%)	4.88	0.35	5.00	32	4.75	0.44	5.00	214	4.81	0.44	5.00

2 - What two or three elements of this course contributed most to your learning?

Response Rate	7/21 (33.33%)

- - prof's willingness to help - prof's time allocation to in class examples
- Creating an environment where I can ask questions without being made to feel stupid
- - the second half period after lecture, where we were given a challenging problem and had to solve. - how the material was presented in a learning manner, making it that anybody who gave 100% effort will not only succeed but learn immensely.
- Class engagement, Helpful study tools provided, and In class questioning
- It really helped reviewing the exam reviews for the test.
- - Office Hours were very helpful. He did a great job at making time for his students and helping us -Practice Problems. They were difficult and I needed a lot of help, but they helped a lot for the tests. Our professor was also very willing to help us and making sure that we understand what is going on.
- Professor Gonzales is one of the best professors I have had at SMU. He is incredibly patient, and allows students to ask questions before class, during class, and after class. He made sure that any questions were answered and understood for the students to be able to grasp the fundamentals of Economics and succeed. He would make sure to explain a concept in multiple ways to make all methods of learning the concept were available. I loved his method of taking part of the class as a lecture, then doing practice problems that were pertinent to the lecture and exams. I hope he is offered a full-time professor position at SMU so I can continue to take classes taught by him.

Southern Methodist University
Dedman - Summer 2023 - 1234

Course: IntermediateMicroeconomics00111234: ECO3301-0011-1234-ECO3301 Sect 0011 1234 : Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez

Instructor: Javier Jose Gonzalez Rodriguez *

Response Rate: 9/21 (42.86 %)

3 - What two or three suggestions would you make to improve this course in the future?

Response Rate	7/21 (33.33%)

- Nothing
- Absolute nothing one of the best teachers at smu
- I honestly cant think of any. My favorite class taken in all of uni.
- I would suggest that the homeworks were worth a few more points I would also suggest that the study guides be more similar to the exams
- Some lessons were difficult. More discussion about the homework problems in class.
- - I can't think of anything major other than taking out some of the extra information. Some of the slides seemed unnecessary, but it wasn't anything that distracted from my learning.
- None.

4 - The following questions are specifically for Dedman College of Humanities and Sciences courses.

10. The instructor provided meaningful and timely feedback on my progress/work in the course.

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Strongly disagree	(1)	1	11.11%		4.56
Disagree	(2)	0	0.00%		
Neither agree nor disagree	(3)	0	0.00%		
Agree	(4)	0	0.00%		
Strongly agree	(5)	8	88.89%		

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Question	Department	College
4.56	4.58	4.64

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	4.56	1.33	5.00	33	4.58	0.79	5.00	212	4.64	0.76	5.00

5 - Please answer the following.

11. Outside of class time, on average how many hours per week did you spend on this course?

Response Option	Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means
Less than 3 hours	(1)	0	0.00%		
3 – 5 hours	(2)	2	22.22%		3.44
5 – 7 hours	(3)	4	44.44%		
7 – 9 hours	(4)	0	0.00%		
More than 9 hours	(5)	3	33.33%		

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Question	Department	College
3.44	3.24	3.28

Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	Department	Mean	STD	Median	College	Mean	STD	Median
9/21 (42.86%)	3.44	1.24	3.00	33	3.24	1.25	3.00	217	3.28	1.35	3.00

Price Theory | ECO 3301-0011 | Summer 2023

Meeting Times & Location: M-T-W-Th-F, 14:00 – 15:50, ULEE 303

Office Hours: 13:00 – 14:00 (Zoom by appointment or Econ Library ULEE 309)

Instructor: Javier Gonzalez (gonzalezjj@smu.edu)

Overview:

Course Description:

This is an intermediate course in microeconomics. The main objective of the course is to the core models of microeconomics. We'll be learning: (i) how to model consumer choice, (ii) how to model firm pricing and production decisions, (iii) the interaction of consumers and firms in markets, (iv) the importance of market structures and market failures.

The course is designed to provide a strong foundation in the tools that underlie economic analysis, including the models used in many upper-level courses you will take. We will analyze economic situations using graphs, ***mathematics***, and intuitive approaches. The best way to succeed in the course is to learn by doing practice problems.

Course goals:

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- discuss and explain economic concepts using graphical representations like demand and supply curves, indifference curves and budget lines, and cost curves.
- solve consumer and firm theory problems and understand how they apply to real-world scenarios.
- use analytical tools to predict pricing and production outcomes under different market structures.
- demonstrate knowledge of microeconomic models.
- demonstrate an ability to analyze complex mathematical problems that arise in particular discipline or area.
- evaluate critically the research outcomes and theoretical applications in economic experiences.

Prerequisites:

ECO 1311, ECO 1312 and MATH 1309 or 1337. We will be using calculus.

Course web page:

The course webpage can be accessed through Canvas. Please check it regularly. Grades, announcements, and other course-related material will be posted there. You are responsible for monitoring all announcements, assignments, and grades. Ensure that your Canvas settings notify you of new announcements.

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Instructor: Javier Gonzalez (gonzalezjj@smu.edu)

Textbooks:

The required textbook is *Perloff, Jeffrey M. Microeconomics: Theory and Applications with Calculus, 4 ed. Pearson 2017*. (You may also use the 5th edition).

If time permits, we are going to focus on the following chapters.

Supply and demand (Ch. 2)
A Consumer's Constrained Choice (Ch. 3)
Demand curves, comparative statics of demand, income and substitution effects (Ch. 4)
Consumer welfare and policy analysis (Ch.5)
Producer theory, production functions, and cost curves (Ch.6 and 7)
Profit maximization, supply curves (Ch. 8)
Competition and analysis of competitive markets (Ch.9 and 10)
Monopoly (Ch. 11)
Game theory (Ch. 13)
Oligopoly and Monopolistic Competition (Ch.14)
Externalities and public goods (Ch. 17)
Asymmetric Information (Ch. 18)

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Instructor: Javier Gonzalez (gonzalezjj@smu.edu)

Grading:

The following weights are the basis for your final grade:

Problem Sets (5 points each)	20%
Midterm 1 (25 points)	25%
Midterm 2 (25 points)	25%
Final Exam (30 points)	30%
Bonus points	up to 10%

Grade	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-
Min score	93	90	87	83	80	77	73	70	67	63	60

Problem Sets

There will be 4 problem sets due on Wednesday at midnight of each week. Then on Thursday we will solve the problem set together on the board in class.

You are allowed (and encouraged) to work on these assignments in groups, but each individual must submit his or her own handwritten assignment. Problem sets will be submitted as .pdfs through Canvas.

Exams

There will be two non-cumulative midterms, each worth 25% of your final grade. There is also a cumulative final exam, worth 30%, which will focus more heavily on the most recent material. Exams will be taken during our allotted class time.

Important Dates

- Problem set 1 - May 31
- Problem set 2 - June 7
- Midterm 1 - June 9
- Problem set 3 - June 14
- Problem set 4 - June 21
- Midterm 2 - June 23
- Final Exam - June 28

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Bonus Points

Students can earn up to 10 points of bonus points in the following activities:

1. (Up to 6 bonus points) For the first 5 minutes I will write some questions on the board about a past lecture (not necessarily the last lecture). Students who answer correctly one question will be awarded a bonus point.
2. (For 4 points) Take one newspaper article or podcast from a reputable news source (New York Times, NBC news, etc), summarize what is the issue they are reporting, and try to explain it using an economic model we have covered in class. More details in Canvas.

Late submissions/make-up exams

Problem sets are due by midnight on the due date and will be submitted as a .pdf through Canvas. Each day of late submission will be discounted by 1 point. (Every problem set will have 5 points)

Schedule conflicts regarding midterms or the final exam should be reported to me immediately.

There will generally be no make-up exams unless the circumstances are truly exceptional and can be substantiated.

Price Theory | ECO 3301-0011 | Summer 2023

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Instructor: Javier Gonzalez (gonzalezjj@smu.edu)

University Policies

Disability Accommodations

Students needing academic accommodations for a disability must first register with Disability Accommodations & Success Strategies (DASS). Students can call 214-768-1470 or visit http://www.smu.edu/Provost/SASP/DASS to begin the process. Once approved and registered, students will submit a DASS Accommodation Letter to faculty through the electronic portal DASS Link and then communicate directly with each instructor to make appropriate arrangements. Please note that accommodations are not retroactive and require advance notice to implement.

Religious Observance

Religiously observant students wishing to be absent on holidays that require missing class should notify their professors in writing at the beginning of the semester, and should discuss with them, in advance, acceptable ways of making up any work missed because of the absence (https://www.smu.edu/StudentAffairs/Chaplain/ReligiousHolidays)

Excused Absences for University Extracurricular Activities

Students participating in an officially sanctioned, scheduled University extracurricular activity should be given the opportunity to make up class assignments or other graded assignments missed as a result of their participation. It is the responsibility of the student to make arrangements with the instructor prior to any missed scheduled examination or other missed assignment for making up the work. (2018-2019 University Undergraduate Catalogue)

Honor Code

Academic misconduct of any kind is prohibited by the SMU Student Honor Code. All work undertaken in this course is governed by the University's honor code - https://www.smu.edu/StudentAffairs/StudentLife/StudentHandbook/HonorCode.